

PALLEBORADIOVAGABONDEDIT

Travel Radio Australia and I'm with a very interesting person, it's Palle Boe and he's in the same business I'm in. He's the famous radio vagabond and he travels all around the world creating fantastic radio segments about travel. Palle, welcome to the program.

Thank you so much. I saw the back of your t-shirt and I had to tap your shoulder and say hey radio guy. That's right.

Now Palle, tell us a bit about your background. How did you get into this crazy world of travel radio broadcasting? I come from a radio background. I've been doing radio since I was in my early 20s and then at some point I could see that my kids would move out of the house so I thought let me go travel for a couple of years.

In the beginning I called my project Around the World in 80 Weeks but that's just a year and a half, that's not enough. So I sold everything, my house, my car, my furniture, my wife and then took off and that was nine years ago and I'm still traveling and because I have that radio background for me it was natural to create a travel podcast. So that's what I'm doing, documenting my journey and taking my microphone to the street so people can hear the sounds of the market of Marrakech or a train in Australia or wherever I am.

Now you're based, well you were based in Denmark, you're Danish so a lot of people might think you're American. I suppose people say that to you but you're actually Danish. There were some people because I have been traveling a lot in the US.

I've been to 48 states and at some point I guess it rubbed off on me so I had a listener write to me and say are you trying to sound American? I said oh god no I just want to speak in neutral English but I have no idea what it is. Now the experiences you've had in nine years, incredible. You've been traveling every week documenting everything for radio and tell us about some of the crazy things that have happened that really stand out for you.

Where to start? I've been to 127 countries so far and sometimes I travel really really fast. In 22 I was in, I slept in 105 different beds and was in more than 30 countries that year so that was quite extreme. I've been to more than half of the countries of Africa and that is I would feel some of the things that stand out.

I recently released some episodes from my trip to Ghana and it was both in Accra, the big city, but also around the country into the small little villages and that's just unique and very different from what we're used to. And tell us about your Australian experiences. I suppose you've had a few of those too? Yeah I had one fairly big trip.

I started up in Sydney as a Dane. I had to go see the Opera House, did the bridge climb to Melbourne and Cairns, did two to three days of scuba diving in the Great Barrier Reef on a boat

and then made my way down to Melbourne and back to Sydney where I jumped on a cruise going to New Zealand. So we did Melbourne again and Tasmania but I haven't been to the western part and I really need to go there also because I've heard that there's a place south of Perth called Denmark and I need to go there and tell them hey you can't steal our name.

But I've seen pictures and it looks amazing and I really want to do the coast as well and I want to do Darwin. You're such a big country man. It's huge, absolutely huge.

A lot of people overseas don't realise that it takes six hours to fly from Sydney to Perth and you haven't even left the country. Fly on a jet, you haven't even left. That is crazy.

I met a guy in Brisbane who said I have this plan that I want to go on a scooter or maybe it was a skateboard from Sydney to Perth and somebody said no no no you don't want to do that. Well I was speaking to somebody who was visiting Sydney and she said oh I want to visit that Ayers Rock thingy, can I get on a bus? I said well you can technically but it's going to take and it's actually rainy season at the moment so you're probably going to take about two weeks if you make it on the bus. And she said oh is it really that far? I said absolutely it is just vast.

Now you're from Denmark and Scandinavia. A lot of people from Australia dream about going to Europe and the Scandinavian regions and Denmark itself is such a beautiful place. You know it inside out.

Tell us a few of the really fun places to go to in Denmark. Yeah because compared to Australia it's so tiny that you can go anywhere within a few hours. So many people they only go to Copenhagen.

Copenhagen is wonderful but it's so easy to get around the country so I would definitely go to what we call the mainland that is not the island Jutland or Jylland as we say and visit Aarhus, the second biggest city in Denmark and then make your way all the way to the northern tip where the two oceans meet. It's Skagen it's called and it's just so unique because it's like a different light up there and a lot of the old classic artists, the painters, they knew that so there's so much art in that place and it can be a bit touristy in the summer but it's absolutely wonderful. So make your way up there and then go jump on some islands as well.

Now we have very big Australian connection with the Queen of Denmark now who is an Australian girl and it's incredibly impressive that she's learned Danish so well. People are blown away. Unbelievable and I think in all the polls she's the most popular person in the royal family.

We love Mary. Yeah that's great to have her and it's funny how they met in Sydney during the prince and the Olympics and it's not a bad pickup line for the guy you know what do you do well I'm a prince you know I'm a crown prince of a major European country. It's not a bad way to you know meet someone is it? No.

It's a great story. Now tell us I'm sure you've run into some extremely interesting characters along the way too. Tell us about a couple of those.

Yeah going back to my Ghana trip I heard that there was a place where they do fantasy coffins like really artistic coffins that you get buried in and it can be shaped as a car or as a lion or in my case it's typically the kind of profession that you had or you're the passion that you had that then you have a fantasy coffin made out of that. They're really beautiful so in my case I would be buried in a microphone and then they could do the microphone drop so I thought that would be a cool way to go but it's a very unique place and Bill Clinton's been there I think more American sitting presidents have visited that place so when I heard about that and I was going to Ghana I reached out and that's the good thing about having a travel podcast I have an excuse to meet interesting people so I went there and and and spoke to the guy who was creating those things but yeah sometimes it's fun stuff and other times it's it's also very serious stuff I was in a in a very poor area of Uganda where an NGO is helping and I got some really remarkable stories in 23 during the war in Ukraine I was all the way in Kharkiv traveled across the country and went to some of the the the villages that was completely bombed out and in and some parts of Buchi where they did the massacre and so getting the stories from my own experience is it's different than just watching it on on the screen and and I suppose when you know a lot of people only travel once or twice a year when you're on the road a lot like we are you're always going on these waves of ups and downs and things go wrong and and it's and but things go right a lot of the times but when things do go wrong you learn to sort of ride with it right exactly you become much more flexible and it's like oh it's it's what happens and I don't know why I'm talking about Ghana so much but when I was entering Ghana you know you have that little yellow book with vaccinations and I had all the stamps I've had all the vaccinations that were required but for some reason the doctor never in his handwriting wrote my name on it so they said oh we can't let you in because there's no name on it and I said can I just write the name no it has to be written by the doctor it's not an official stamp it's just his handwriting and then he mumbles something about well I can pay some money and I and I said um can I speak to your superior and he said a woman happened to pass by and says that yeah that's me and then I said very politely I do believe this gentleman is asking me for a bribe I said no no no we don't do that we don't do that and then then and I was let in but they were talking about confiscating the card which would be a huge issue for me you you roll with those punches and and and make it work and as long as it doesn't kill you it's uh at least I I know that I'm in the middle of a good story and here I am talking to you about a thing that happened that wasn't according to plan that's where the really good stories are honestly well maybe they had a special little holiday lined up for you in a in a um spartan hotel room somewhere if you pushed your luck too much it could be it could be I don't know I I I didn't think it was that serious the most serious thing was that they will that would send me away and they wouldn't let me enter or they would confiscate the the vaccine card which would have been a big issue now we're speaking to palabo who's a the radio vagabond he travels all around the world creating beautiful content with interesting people destinations to and you're

here at the world travel market what's your opinion of the world travel market it must be fantastic here for you and and me it really is yeah it's it's so intense and and and so so massive and this year it's bigger than ever as far as I know it can really get intense I I've set up some meetings so I'm talking to some of the the the destinations I would like to go to and if with a bit of luck they invite me on a on a trip there and so that's kind of my goal for being here and also meeting up with old friends and making new ones well it's great to have you on travel radio australia palabo that's p a double l e space b o the radio vagabond how can people find out about more about you online it's simply go to the radiovagabond.com and if you want to see all the links then you add a slash link tree then you have all but the radio on this way you find everything and can you say hello to our danish born people who live in australia there's a lot who live in australia i in danish i sure can hi me yeah the air fantastic or come to a stockman yeah they're bored they're needed down under oh wait this time on them uh the hurt is uh smith one linea for the second we can that's fantastic that's great and thank you so much for being on the show and great travels and may there for both of us be so many more fantastic world experiences thank you jeff it was a pleasure